

ATmega32A Module

ADC (Analog-to-Digital Converter)

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1 Theory

The world outside the microcontroller is *analog*: a voltage can have any value, for example 1.37 V. The CPU can only work with numbers. An ADC (*Analog-to-Digital Converter*) measures a voltage and gives you a number.

Resolution and reference. The ATmega32A has a **10-bit** ADC. So the result is a number from 0 to $2^{10} - 1 = 1023$. The *reference voltage* V_{REF} is the largest voltage the ADC can measure. On our board $V_{\text{REF}} = 5 \text{ V}$. One step of the result (1 LSB) is

$$1 \text{ LSB} = \frac{V_{\text{REF}}}{1024} = \frac{5 \text{ V}}{1024} \approx 4.9 \text{ mV}$$

and the result for an input voltage V_{IN} is

$$\text{value} = \frac{V_{\text{IN}} \cdot 1024}{V_{\text{REF}}} \qquad V_{\text{IN}} = \frac{\text{value} \cdot V_{\text{REF}}}{1024}$$

Input voltage	10-bit value	8-bit value
0 V	0	0
1.25 V	256	64
2.5 V	512	128
3.75 V	768	192
5 V	1023	255

If 8 bits are enough (for example for 8 LEDs or for PWM), we use only the upper 8 bits of the result: 0 to 255.

Channels. There is only one ADC, but it has a multiplexer with 8 inputs: **ADC0–ADC7** on the pins **PA0–PA7**. You choose the channel for each measurement.

Conversion time. The ADC needs its own clock between 50 and 200 kHz for the full 10-bit accuracy. It is made from the CPU clock with a prescaler. One conversion takes 13 ADC clock cycles: at 125 kHz this is about $104 \mu\text{s}$.

2 How to use the driver

The driver gives you one object: `ADC`. You start it once with `ADC.begin()`, then you read a channel whenever you need a value.

Functions

Function	What it does
<code>ADC.begin()</code>	Switch the ADC on. Reference = AREF (5 V on our board). The driver chooses the ADC clock from <code>F_CPU</code> (8 MHz / 64 = 125 kHz)
<code>ADC.read(channel)</code>	Measure the voltage on <i>PAchannel</i> (channel 0–7) and return 0–1023. It waits until the conversion is finished (about 104 μ s)
<code>ADC.read8(channel)</code>	The same, but only the upper 8 bits: 0–255. Good for LEDs and PWM
<code>ADC.readMillivolts(channel)</code>	The same, in millivolts: 0–4995 mV

The `pin. read()` makes the pin an *input* and switches its pull-up resistor *off*. A pull-up would change the voltage that you want to measure. So you do not need `GPIO.setDirection()` for an ADC pin.

Reference voltage on our board. On the course board the pins `VCC`, `AVCC` and `AREF` are all connected to +5 V. For this reason the driver always uses `AREF` as the reference. The internal 2.56 V reference must not be used on this board: it would be connected to the 5 V on the `AREF` pin.

Driver functions and registers

In the lecture slides we set the registers by hand. Each driver function does these steps for you:

Driver function	Registers
<code>ADC.begin()</code>	<code>ADMUX = 0; (REFS1:0 = 00: AREF; ADLAR = 0)</code> <code>ADCSRA = (1<<ADEN) (1<<ADPS2) (1<<ADPS1); (prescaler 64 at 8 MHz)</code>
<code>ADC.read(0)</code>	<code>DDRA &= ~(1<<PA0); PORTA &= ~(1<<PA0); (input, no pull-up)</code> <code>ADMUX = (ADMUX & 0xE0) 0; (MUX4:0 = channel)</code> <code>ADCSRA = (1<<ADSC); while (ADCSRA & (1<<ADSC));</code> <code>return ADCW; (ADCL first, then ADCH)</code>
<code>ADC.read8(0)</code>	<code>ADC.read(0) >> 2 (the same as ADLAR = 1 and reading only ADCH)</code>
<code>ADC.readMillivolts(0)</code>	<code>ADC.read(0) * 5000 / 1024</code>

3 Example: a small voltmeter

Board hardware.

- **Potentiometer** R13 (10 k Ω) on PA0 = **ADC0**. Turn it to change the voltage on PA0 from 0 to 5 V.
- **8 LEDs (D0–D7) on PORTB**, active-low: LOW = ON. LED **D3** is on PB3 = 0C0, the PWM output of Timer0.
- **USB-UART** (FT232) on PD0/PD1: open a serial terminal with 9600 baud, 8N1 (see the UART handout).

Build and upload. `make adc`. Open the terminal and turn the potentiometer. You see for example ADC = 759 (3706 mV).

```
/*
 * ADC Example -- a small voltmeter: read the potentiometer and send the
 * result to the PC two times per second.
 * Build & flash: make adc
 *
 * Open a serial terminal on the PC: 9600 baud, 8N1. Turn the potentiometer
 * and watch the numbers, for example:
 *   ADC = 759 (3706 mV)
 *
 * The potentiometer of the board is on PA0 (ADC channel 0).
 */

#define F_CPU 8000000UL
#include "../uart/uart.hpp"
#include "adc.hpp"

int main() {
    UART.begin(9600);
    ADC.begin(); // reference AREF = 5 V, ADC clock 125 kHz

    while (true) {
        uint16_t value = ADC.read(0);           // 0..1023
        uint16_t mv = ADC.readMillivolts(0);    // 0..4995 mV

        UART.print("ADC = ");
        UART.print(value);
        UART.print(" (");
        UART.print(mv);
        UART.println(" mV)");

        _delay_ms(500);
    }
}
```

4 Laboratory Tasks

For each task, make a new .cpp file in the main project folder (for example Task1.cpp). Start the file with `#define F_CPU 8000000UL`. Then include the drivers you need: `drivers/adc/adc.hpp`, `drivers/gpio/gpio.hpp`, `drivers/timer/timer.hpp`, `drivers/uart/uart.hpp`. Upload it with `make SRC=Task1.cpp`.

Task 1: Potentiometer on the LEDs (25 min)

Read the potentiometer (channel 0) and show the value on the 8 LEDs on PORTB. Use `ADC.read8(0)`, because there are only 8 LEDs. The LEDs are active-low, so write the inverted value: `GPIO.write(PORTB, ~value)`.

Turn the potentiometer from one end to the other. Which LEDs are on at the two ends? Which value do you read in the middle?

Task 2: Potentiometer Sets the LED Brightness (20 min)

Use the potentiometer to set the brightness of LED D3 (PB3 = OC0):

1. Start Timer0 in `TIMER_FAST_PWM` mode with `PWM_INVERTING` (the LED is active-low), as in the timer lesson.
2. In the loop, read the potentiometer with `ADC.read8(0)` and write the value with `Timer0.setCompare()`.

Now the potentiometer works like a light dimmer.

Assignment: Find the Cross Voltage

The pin PA0 can be read in two ways: as an *analog* value with the ADC, and as a *digital* value (0 or 1) with `GPIO.read(PINA, PA0)`. At some input voltage the digital value changes from 0 to 1. Find this *cross voltage*.

1. In the loop, read both values of PA0: `ADC.readMillivolts(0)` and `GPIO.read(PINA, PA0)`.
2. Send both to the PC with the UART (Lesson 6), for example 3706 mV -> 1, about 10 times per second.
3. Turn the potentiometer *slowly* from 0 V up to 5 V. At which voltage does the digital value change from 0 to 1?
4. Now turn it slowly back down. At which voltage does it change from 1 to 0? Is it the same voltage? Compare your results with the input voltages V_{IL} and V_{IH} in the datasheet (*Electrical Characteristics*).